

Opening the Doors, Step by Step

Registration, licensing, location, and the sequence of an actual practice launch

Learning Objectives

- Complete the correct business registration and licensing sequence
- Evaluate a location against practical, non-sentimental criteria
- Plan a soft launch that gathers real feedback before a full public opening
- Explain why sequence, not just completeness, determines a smooth launch

Order matters here too

Just as Course VI's Module Eleven taught that a bridal application sequence fails if performed out of order, opening a practice fails in avoidable ways when steps are skipped or reordered — signing a lease before confirming zoning permits it for a beauty business, for instance, or opening publicly before licensing is confirmed.

1. **Business registration.** Register your business structure through the appropriate local authority before signing any binding commitment.
2. **Licensing and permits.** Confirm the specific health, safety, and professional licensing requirements for your services and location — these vary by region and service type, and must be confirmed, not assumed.
3. **Location evaluation.** Assess foot traffic, parking or accessibility, proximity to your target client base, and lease terms against the pricing formula from Module Four, not against sentiment alone.
4. **Insurance and financial setup.** Complete Module Nine's financial kit before, not after, opening.

5. **Soft launch.** Serve a small, invited group of clients first, gathering honest feedback and refining operations before a full public opening.
6. **Public opening.** Launch fully, with systems and pricing already tested rather than being built live in front of paying strangers.

Evaluating a location honestly

A charming space in the wrong location, or at a rent your calculated pricing cannot support, is a genuine business risk regardless of how much you love it. Run the numbers from Module Four against a specific lease's actual monthly cost before falling in love with any single option.

Key Terms

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Practical Activity · Build the Launch Plan

Draft a full six-step launch plan for a hypothetical practice, including specific criteria you would use to evaluate a location and what you would ask soft-launch clients for feedback on.